

History year wise PYQ

PRE HISTORY:

1. Mesolithic rock cut architecture of India not only reflects the cultural life of the times but also a fine aesthetic sense comparable to modern painting. Critically evaluate this comment. 2015

INDUS VALLEY CIVILIZATION:

2. To what extent has the urban planning and culture of the Indus Valley Civilization provided inputs to the present-day urbanization? Discuss.
3. The ancient civilization in Indian sub-continent differed from those of Egypt, Mesopotamia and Greece in that its culture and traditions have been preserved without a breakdown to the present day. Comment. 2015
4. Discuss the salient features of the Harappan architecture. (Answer in 150 words) 2025

VEDIC CULTURE:

5. What are the main features of Vedic society and religion? Do you think some of the features are still prevailing in Indian society. (Answer in 250 words) 2023
6. Underline the changes in the field of society and economy from the Rig Vedic to the later Vedic period (Answer in 150 words) 2024

BUDDHISM AND JAINISM:

7. Gandhara sculpture owed as much to the Romans as to the Greeks. Explain. 2014

8. Early Buddhist Stupa-art, while depicting folk motifs and narratives successfully expounds Buddhist ideals. Elucidate 2016
9. Highlight the Central Asian and Greco -Bactrian elements in Gandhara art. 2019
10. Pala period is the most significant phase in the history of Buddhism in India. Enumerate. 2020

GUPTAN

11. How do you justify the view that the level of excellence of Gupta numismatic art is not at all noticeable in later times? 2017

SANGAM AGE

12. Though not very useful from the point of view of a connected political history of South India, the Sangam literature portrays the social and economic conditions of its time with remarkable vividness. Comment. 2013

DELHI SULTANATE

13. What were the major technological changes introduced during the Sultanate period? How did those technological changes influence the Indian society (Answer in 250 words) 2023

BHAKTI AND SUFI MOVEMENT

14. Sufis and medieval mystic saints failed to modify either the religious ideas and practices or the outward structure of Hindu / Muslim societies to any appreciable extent. Comment. 2014
15. The Bhakti movement received a remarkable reorientation with the advent of Sri Chaitanya Mahaprabhu. Discuss 2018
16. Evaluate the nature of the Bhakti Literature and its contribution to Indian culture. (Answer in 150 words) 2021

TEMPLE ARCHITECTURE

17. Chola architecture represents a high watermark in the evolution of temple architecture. Discuss. 2013
18. How will you explain the medieval Indian temple sculptures represent the social life of those days? (Answer in 150 words) 2022
19. “Though the great Cholas are no more yet their name is still remembered with great pride because of their highest achievements in the domain of art and architecture” Comment (Answer in 250 words) 2024
20. The sculptors filled the Chandela artform with resilient Vigor and breadth of life. Elucidate. (Answer in 150 words) 2025

DANCE AND MUSIC

21. Discuss the Tandava dance as recorded in the early Indian inscriptions. 2013

SOURCES, CULTURE AND HERITAGE

22. Though not very useful from the point of view of a connected political history of South India, the Sangam literature portrays the social and economic conditions of its time with remarkable vividness. Comment 2013.
23. Taxila university was one of the oldest universities of the world with which were associated a number of renowned learned personalities of different disciplines. Its strategic location caused its fame to flourish, but unlike Nalanda, it is not considered as a university in the modern sense. Discuss. 2014
24. Krishnadeva Raya, the King of Vijayanagar, was not only an accomplished scholar himself but was also a great patron of learning and literature. Discuss. 2016

25. Assess the importance of the accounts of the Chinese and Arab travellers in the reconstruction of the history of India. • Safeguarding the Indian art heritage is the need of the moment. Discuss. 2018
26. The rock-cut architecture represents one of the most important sources of our knowledge of early Indian art and history. Discuss. 2020
27. Indian philosophy and tradition played a significant role in conceiving and shaping the monuments and art in India. Discuss 2020
28. Persian literary sources of medieval India reflect the spirit of the age. Comment? 2020
29. Discuss the main contributions of Gupta period and Chola period to Indian heritage and culture. (Answer in 250 words) 2022
30. Discuss the significance of the lion and bull figures in Indian mythology, art and architecture. (Answer in 250 words) 2022
31. Estimate the contribution of Pallavas of Kanchi for the development of art and literature of South India. (Answer in 150 words) 2024
32. Examine the main aspects of Akbar's religious syncretism. (Answer in 150 words) 2025

GREAT REVOLT

33. Explain how the Uprising of 1857 constitutes an important watershed in the evolution of British policies towards colonial India. 2016
34. The 1857 Uprising was the culmination the recurrent big and small local rebellions that had occurred in the preceding hundred years of British rule. Elucidate. 2019

SOCIO RELIGIOUS REFORM MOVEMENT

35. The women's questions arose in modern India as a part of the 19th century social reform movement. What were the major issues and debates concerning women in that period? 2017
36. Examine the linkages between 19th centuries 'Indian Renaissance' and the emergence of national identity. 2019
37. Trace the rise and growth of socio-religious reform movements with special reference to Young Bengal and Brahmo Samaj. (Answer in 150 words) 2021

PERSONALITIES

38. In many ways, Lord Dalhousie was the founder of modern India. Elaborate. 2013
39. Mahatma Jyotirao Phule's writings and efforts of social reforms touched issues of almost all subaltern classes. Discuss. (150 words) 2013

ECONOMIC IMPACT

40. Examine critically the various facets of economic policies of the British in India from mid-eighteenth century till independence. 2014
41. Examine how the decline of traditional artisanal industry in colonial India crippled the rural economy. 2017
42. Why was there a sudden spurt in famines in colonial India since the mid-eighteenth century? Give reasons. (Answer in 150 words) 2022

INC

43. Why did the 'Moderates' fail to carry conviction with the nation about their proclaimed ideology and political goals by the end of the nineteenth century? 2017

44. To what extent did the role of the moderates prepare a base for the wider freedom movement? Comment. (Answer in 250 words) 2021

GANDHIAN

45. How different would have been the achievement of Indian independence without Mahatma Gandhi? Discuss. 2015

46. Mahatma Gandhi and Dr. B.R. Ambedkar, despite having divergent approaches and strategies, had a common goal of amelioration of the downtrodden. Elucidate. 2015

47. Highlight the differences in the approach of Subhash Chandra Bose and Mahatma Gandhi in the struggle for freedom. 2016

48. Discuss the role of women in the freedom struggle especially during the Gandhian phase. 2016

49. Throw light on the significance of the thoughts of Mahatma Gandhi in the present times. 2018

50. Many voices had strengthened and enriched the nationalist movement during the Gandhian phase. Elaborate. 2019

51. Bring out the constructive programmes of Mahatma Gandhi during Non-Cooperation Movement and Civil Disobedience Movement. (Answer in 250 words) 2021

52. What was the difference between Mahatma Gandhi and Rabindranath Tagore in their approach towards education and nationalism? (Answer in 150 words) 2023

WORLD WAR

53. To what extent can Germany be held responsible for causing the two World Wars? Discuss critically 2015

54. “There arose a serious challenge to the Democratic State System between the two World Wars.” Evaluate the statement. (Answer in 250 words) 2021

55. How far is it correct to say that the First World War was fought essentially for the preservation of balance of power? (Answer in 250 words) 2024